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RSV in Pregnancy

Protecting you and your newborn from Respiratory Syncytial Virus — the #1 cause of infant hospitalization

WHAT IS RSV?

Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV) is a **common respiratory virus** that causes cold-like symptoms in most adults but can be **extremely dangerous for newborns and infants**, especially in the first 6 months of life.

RSV in Infants Can Cause:

- Bronchiolitis (lower airway inflammation)
- Pneumonia
- Difficulty breathing — hospitalization required
- RSV is the **#1 cause of infant hospitalization** in the US
- ~58,000–80,000 children <5 years hospitalized annually

RSV Season:

- Peak season: October through March
- Spreads via respiratory droplets and surfaces
- Adults can spread RSV even with mild or no symptoms

RSV VACCINE IN PREGNANCY

Abrysvo® RSV Vaccine

Pfizer — FDA approved for use in pregnancy

Timing: 32–36 weeks of pregnancy (September–January)

A single-dose injection given to the pregnant person. Antibodies cross the placenta, providing **passive immunity to the newborn from birth** through the most vulnerable first months of life.

Vaccine Benefits:

- Reduces severe RSV in infants by ~69% in first 6 months
- Reduces infant hospitalization for RSV
- Protection begins immediately at birth — no waiting
- Safe for both mother and baby based on clinical trials

NIRSEVIMAB (BEYFORTUS®)

If the RSV vaccine was not received during pregnancy, your newborn can receive **Nirsevimab (Beyfortus®)** — a monoclonal antibody injection — shortly after birth.

Nirsevimab Facts:

- Not a vaccine — it's a preventive antibody injection
- Recommended for all infants born during or entering RSV season
- Single dose given at birth or first RSV season
- Reduces severe RSV illness by ~76% in clinical trials
- Given at the hospital after delivery or by your pediatrician

Note: Both vaccine and nirsevimab may be used, but the vaccine provides similar protection — discuss timing with Dr. Klein.

ADDITIONAL PROTECTION TIPS

Hand hygiene: Wash hands frequently — ask everyone to wash before holding newborn

Sick visitors: No visiting if anyone has cold/respiratory symptoms

Avoid crowds: Limit exposure of newborns to public places during RSV season (Oct–March)

No smoking: Secondhand smoke significantly increases RSV severity in infants

Breastfeeding: Provides antibodies and additional immune protection to your baby

If Your Baby Shows These Signs, Seek Care Immediately:

- Rapid or labored breathing, flared nostrils
- Blue lips or fingernails (cyanosis)
- Not eating well, extreme fatigue

The RSV Vaccine Is One of the Most Impactful Things You Can Do for Your Newborn

We strongly recommend the RSV vaccine for all eligible pregnant patients between 32–36 weeks. This simple step can keep your baby out of the hospital during their most vulnerable first months. Questions? Call us at **(281) 557-0300**

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